

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM, EDR/XDR, Infrastructure Hardening, Threat Detection and Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience protecting complex enterprise environments. I have direct expertise in managing and optimising Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation, and Response (SOAR) platforms, administering Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) tooling including CrowdStrike Falcon, and hardening security across global infrastructure. In my current role at the University of the Arts London, I have taken technical ownership of the full security stack covering email and web security gateways, firewall management, identity and access management, and vulnerability management across an estate of over 8,000 users. I work closely with senior security leadership, communicate clearly with both technical and non-technical stakeholders, and thrive in lean, high-impact security teams where individual technical expertise directly influences the organisation's security posture. I am now seeking a senior engineering role within a focused team where I can apply my breadth of skills to protect a global infrastructure and contribute to continuous security improvement.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM/SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL), SOAR playbook development, Splunk (Security Information and Event Management)
- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast, email gateway management, web content filtering, phishing investigation and response
- **Infrastructure Hardening:** Firewall policy management and optimisation (Check Point Harmony), network segmentation, Microsoft gateway security, Web Application Firewall (WAF) and Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) protection concepts
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Azure Active Directory / Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus, remediation tracking
- **Incident Response:** NIST Special Publication 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, full incident lifecycle management
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR automation, workflow development
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Tanium, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) Senior Cyber Security Analyst (Engineer)

March 2025 - Present

- Take technical ownership of implementing, maintaining, and hardening the security stack across an estate of over 8,000 users, spanning endpoint, email, network, identity, and cloud environments.
- Administer and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), configuring detection policies, alert tuning, and threat hunting workflows to reduce dwell time and improve response fidelity.

- Manage and maintain the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM platform, developing and refining Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries, analytics rules, and workbooks to detect and respond to threats across the enterprise.
- Oversee Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, managing alert triage, incident escalation, and remediation.
- Administer Mimecast email security gateway, managing policies for anti-phishing, anti-spoofing, URL rewriting, and malware sandboxing to protect the organisation's communications infrastructure.
- Manage Check Point Harmony firewall, maintaining and optimising rule sets, performing periodic reviews, and ensuring network segmentation aligns with security policy.
- Lead end-to-end incident response activities following the NIST 800-61 framework, coordinating detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access and manage privileged credentials across the estate.
- Manage Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Entra ID), Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO) to strengthen identity security.
- Drive the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentra BAS, prioritising findings by risk exposure and tracking remediation through to closure.
- Develop SOAR playbooks and PowerShell automation scripts to streamline repetitive security operations tasks, reducing manual effort and accelerating response times.
- Manage Tanium endpoint management and Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) to ensure device compliance and security baseline enforcement.

University of the Arts London (UAL) Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and triaged security alerts from SIEM and EDR/XDR platforms, escalating incidents and coordinating response in line with organisational procedures and security frameworks.
- Supported the hardening of the university's security infrastructure, contributing to firewall rule reviews, email gateway policy updates, and endpoint protection configuration.
- Investigated security incidents including phishing attempts, malware infections, and unauthorised access events, producing detailed incident reports and remediation recommendations.
- Administered Azure Active Directory, Conditional Access policies, and Identity Protection features, assisting with the rollout of Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) across the organisation.
- Contributed to vulnerability scanning activities using Tenable.io and Nessus, analysing results and liaising with IT teams to drive timely remediation of critical and high-severity findings.
- Developed SIEM detection use cases and tuned existing rules to reduce false positives and improve the signal-to-noise ratio for the security operations team.
- Supported the procurement, evaluation, and onboarding of security tooling, including assessment of EDR solutions for enterprise deployment.
- Produced regular security reporting and metrics for IT leadership, communicating risk exposure and operational performance in clear, non-technical language.

HEX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and maintained security controls within a Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) environment, aligning practices with ISO 27001 and industry security standards.
- Managed endpoint security, network access controls, and identity management solutions across the organisation's infrastructure.
- Supported cloud infrastructure security on Microsoft Azure, enforcing access policies and monitoring for misconfigurations.
- Performed security quality assurance testing and contributed to vulnerability assessments, identifying and escalating risks for remediation.
- Partnered with development and operations teams to embed security into the software development lifecycle, applying security-by-design principles to product and infrastructure changes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the enterprise-wide deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM across an 8,000-user estate, significantly improving threat visibility and reducing mean time to detect security incidents.
- Deployed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) across the organisation, eliminating the use of shared administrative credentials and materially reducing the attack surface for credential-based attacks.
- Developed a library of custom Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, enabling automated alerting for high-priority attack patterns aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Built and operationalised SOAR automation playbooks using PowerShell scripting, cutting average incident triage time by streamlining alert enrichment and initial response workflows.
- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate the effectiveness of security controls, enabling proactive identification and closure of detection gaps.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification for the organisation, demonstrating compliance with core technical security controls across network, endpoint, and identity domains.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)